

ARIANE 5

Rocket

Launched from the French Guiana Space Centre in South America, the European Space Agency's Ariane 5 is a world-leading rocket for launching massive satellites. It has launched European resupply craft to the International Space Station, and will soon send a spacecraft to Mercury. Ariane 5 will launch the James Webb Space Telescope – the successor to Hubble.

DATA FILE



SIZE: 52 m (170 ft) tall



FIRST LAUNCH: 4 June 1996



NUMBER OF MISSIONS: 86 (ongoing)



SPACE AGENCY: ESA

The payload fairing protects the satellite during launch

On 1 July 2009, Ariane 5 launched the largest telecommunications satellite ever built.